

Tuanzebe found himself in the right place at the right time to steer home from close range and settle the Intercontinental Playoff against Jamaica. A strong CAF qualifying campaign, in which the side finished second behind Senegal, underlined that its place at the finals was thoroughly deserved.

The Leopards possess an experienced back four capable of frustrating any opponent on their day and will need their forwards to provide enough cutting edge to fuel an unlikely push for qualification.

Uzbekistan has already made history by qualifying for the World Cup for the first time. The side excelled during the second and third rounds of AFC qualifying, losing just one match to secure its place.

Despite Timur Kapadze guiding the team to its maiden World Cup appearance, the White Wolves opted for a different approach in dealing with the pressures of the tournament, appointing Fabio Cannavaro as head coach in 2025. The 2006 World Cup-winning captain will hope to transfer his experience of football's grandest stage to a youthful Uzbek squad that will arrive with little fear.



Cedric Bakambu (DR Congo)

In a professional career spanning 16 years, Bakambu has scored goals across seven countries. The numbers, however, have dipped in recent seasons. DR Congo will need its captain to rediscover his best form if it is to make a mark at the tournament, particularly with strike partner Yoanne Wissa also struggling for consistency.



Abdukodir Khusanov (Uzbekistan)

The 22-year-old defender has enjoyed a breakthrough year in Manchester City colours, deputising admirably for the injured Ruben Dias. Already a 25-cap international, Khusanov will be expected to lead by example as Uzbekistan embarks on its first World Cup campaign.

SQUADS

Portugal

Goalkeepers: Diogo Costa, José Sá, Rui Silva

Defenders: Rúben Dias, João Cancelo, Diogo Dalot, Nuno Mendes, Nélon Semedo, Matheus Nunes, Gonçalo Inacio, Renato Veiga, Tomás Araújo

Midfielders: Bruno Fernandes, Bernardo Silva, Vitinha, João Neves, Rúben Neves, Samú Costa

Forwards: Cristiano Ronaldo, Rafael Leão, João Félix, Gonçalo Ramos, Pedro Neto, Francisco Conceição, Gonçalo Guedes, Francisco Trincão

Colombia

Goalkeepers: David Ospina, Álvaro Montero, Camilo Vargas

Defenders: Daniel Muñoz, Jhon Lucumí, Santiago Arias, Davinson Sánchez, Johan Mojica, Yerry Mina, Willer Ditta, Deiver Machado

Midfielders: Jorge Carrascal, Kevin Castaño, Gustavo Puerta, Juan Fernando Quintero, Juan Portilla, Jefferson Lerma, Richard Ríos, Jhon Arias, James Rodríguez, Jaminton Campaz

Forwards: Luis Díaz, Jhon Córdoba, Luis Suárez, Carlos Andrés Gómez, Juan Camilo Hernández

DR Congo

Goalkeepers: Lionel Mpasi, Timothy Fayulu, Matthieu Epolo

Defenders: Chancel Mbemba, Axel Tuanzebe, Arthur Masuaku, Gedeon Kalulu, Joris Kayembe, Aaron Wan-Bissaka, Aaron Tshibola, Steve Kapuadi, Dylan Batubinsika

Midfielders: Noah Sadiki, Charles Pickel, Edo Kayembe, Samuel Moutoussamy, Ngal'ayel Mukau, Nathanaël Mbuku, Meschak Elia, Brian Cipenga, Gaël Kakuta

Forwards: Simon Banza, Yoane Wissa, Fiston Mayele, Cédric Bakambu, Théo Bongonda

Uzbekistan

Goalkeepers: O'tkir Yusupov, Botirali Ergashev, Abduvohid Ne'matov

Defenders: Abduqodir Husanov, Hojiakbar Alijonov, Farruh Sayfiev, Rustam Ashurmatov, Sherzod Nasrullaev, Umar Eshmurodov, Avazbek O'lmasaliev, Jahongir O'rozov, Behruzjon Karimov, Abdulla Abdullaev

Midfielders: Akmal Mozgovoy, Otabek Shukurov, Jamshid Iskanderov, Odil Hamrobekov, Jaloliddin Masharipov, Aziz G'aniev, Sherzod Esanov, Abbosbek Fayzullaev

Forwards: Eldor Shomurodov, Igor Sergeev, Azizbek Amonov, Oston O'runov, Dostonbek Hamdamov